creed had been extended, and the people of Islam had waxen strong and warlike, the names of these men had fallen into neglect and oblivion. So I decreed that according to established custom their names and titles should be rehearsed in the khutba and aspirations offered for the remission of their sins.

18 Ahmad Sirhindi writes as below in a letter (Sirhindi, 1988) criticising the steps taken by Akbar written to Shaikh Farid alias Nawab Murtaza Khan who was opposed to Akbar's religious policy, and who supported Jahangir's accession after taking from the latter a promise that Islam will be upheld in the new reign:

Islam and infidelity (kufr) contradict one another. To establish the one means eradicating the other, the coming together of these contradictories being impossible. Therefore, Allah has commanded his Prophet to wage war (jihad) against the infidels and be harsh with them. (. . .) The abolition of jizyah in Hindustan is a result of friendship which (Hindus) have acquired with the rulers of this land . . . What right have the rulers to stop exacting jizyah? (. . .)

19 Common sense might suggest that here was a striking example of a refutable hypothesis that had in fact been refuted. Indo-European scholars should have scrapped all their historical reconstructions and started again from scratch. But that is not what happened. Vested interests and academic posts were involved. Almost without exception the scholars in question managed to persuade themselves that despite appearances the theories of the philologists and the hard evidence of archeology could be made to fit together. The trick was to think of the horse-riding Aryans as conquerors of the cities of the Indus civilization in the same way that the Spanish conquistadores were conquerors of the cities of Mexico and Peru or the Israelites of the Exodus were conquerors of Jericho. The lowly Dasa of the Rig Veda, who had previously been thought of as primitive savages, were now reconstructed as members of a high civilization. (Leach, 1990)

20 This is highly problematic narrative because it pushes us to believe India was fragmented because of language in the past. But had that been the truth how could Aadi Shankaracharya, travel down from south of India up to Kashmir and preach *Vedanta*? We have records wherein people of past interacted with people of different regions with varied languages and people used to be multilingual.

21 To begin to tell these tales Sanjeev Sanyal came up with his book *Revolutionaries*and Vikram Sampath with *Bravehearts of Bharat*.

22 The normal projection of Indian History has been that India was a fragmented country and was never united. Any attempt of someone to demystify the truths around Islamic Invasion or related subjects, gets a strong backlash because the normally accepted narrative is not in favour of those demystifications. Often that gets taglines like, '*saffronization'* and more with bulk of attacks flowing through the media pieces.